

FACTORS TO CONSIDER

When deciding how firm or intense you want to be in asking or saying no, think about:

1. The other person's or your own **capability**.
2. Your **priorities**.
3. The effect of your actions on your **self-respect**.
4. Your or the other's moral and legal **rights** in the situation.
5. Your **authority** over the person (or his or hers over you).
6. The type of **relationship** you have with the person.
7. The effect of your action on **long- versus short-term goals**.
8. The degree of **give and take** in your relationship.
9. Whether you have done your **homework** to prepare.
10. The **timing** of your request or refusal.

- 1. CAPABILITY:**
 - Is the person able to give you what you want? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
 - Do you have what the person wants? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.
- 2. PRIORITIES:**
 - Are your GOALS very important? Increase intensity.
 - Is your RELATIONSHIP shaky? Consider reducing intensity.
 - Is your SELF-RESPECT on the line? Intensity should fit your values.
- 3. SELF-RESPECT:**
 - Do you usually do things for yourself? Are you careful to avoid acting helpless when you are not? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
 - Will saying no make you feel bad about yourself, even when you are thinking about it wisely? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.
- 4. RIGHTS:**
 - Is the person required by law or moral code to give you what you want? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
 - Are you required to give the person what he or she is asking for? Would saying no violate the other person's rights? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.
- 5. AUTHORITY:**
 - Are you responsible for directing the person or telling the person what to do? If YES, raise the intensity of ASKING.
 - Does the person have authority over you (e.g., your boss, your teacher)? And is what the person is asking within his or her authority? If NO, raise the intensity of NO.

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